PROJECT: ENFORCING MANDATORY FIELDS USING UI POLICIES AND MIGRATING CHANGES WITH UPDATE SETS

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Overview of ServiceNow:

ServiceNow is a cloud-based platform used for IT Service Management (ITSM). It helps organizations manage services, workflows, and incidents efficiently through automation. Instead of handling requests manually, ServiceNow simplifies business processes and improves service delivery. In this project, UI Policies are used to make important fields mandatory before processing an incident, and Update Sets are used to migrate the configuration between instances.

1.2 Project Overview :

In ServiceNow, incidents are created and updated regularly with fields like description, priority, and state. Sometimes users change the incident state to “In Progress” without setting the priority, which can cause confusion for support teams. To solve this issue, a UI Policy is created to make the Priority field mandatory when the State is set to “In Progress.” This project also

demonstrates how Update Sets are used to capture and move configuration changes between ServiceNow instances.

Purpose of the Project:

The main purpose of this project is to ensure that important information is provided when incidents are updated in ServiceNow. It improves data accuracy by making the Priority field mandatory using UI Policies when the incident state changes to “In Progress.” The project also demonstrates how Update Sets are used to transfer configuration changes between ServiceNow environments and improve workflow efficiency.

2. PROPBLEM STATEMENT

Incident management requires accurate information to handle issues effectively. The Priority field is important because it determines how urgent an incident is. Sometimes users change the incident state to “In Progress” without assigning a priority, which can lead to delays and poor task management. To solve this problem, a UI Policy is implemented to make the Priority field mandatory when the State is set to “In Progress.”

3. OBJECTIVES OF THE PROJECT

The objectives of this project are:

- To understand the functionality of UI Policies in ServiceNow.
- To enforce mandatory fields dynamically without writing scripts.
- To improve the quality and completeness of incident data.
- To capture configuration changes using Update Sets.
- To demonstrate how Update Sets can be exported and imported between instances.
- To test and verify the working of the UI Policy in the incident module.

4. SYSTEM ANALYSIS

4.1 Existing System

In the existing system, incident records can be updated without strict validation rules. Users may leave important fields empty when updating the status of an incident.For example, a user may set the incident state to “In

Progress” without specifying the priority. This leads to incomplete records and can affect the efficiency of incident management.

The limitations of the existing system include:

- Lack of mandatory validation for important fields
- Incomplete incident records
- Difficulty in prioritizing tasks
- Poor workflow management

4.2 Proposed System

The proposed system introduces a UI Policy that automatically controls the behavior of fields in the incident form.

When the State field changes to “In Progress,” the Priority field becomes mandatory. This ensures that users must select a priority level before saving the record.

The system also uses Update Sets to capture and migrate configuration changes. This allows developers to move the implemented solution to other ServiceNow environments easily

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4. PROJECT DESIGN :

4.1 Problem Solution Fit :

The Smart Library Request Workflow system solves the problem of manual library request management. Instead of paper-based requests, users can submit requests digitally through ServiceNow forms.

The system automatically processes requests using workflows and allows library administrators to manage them efficiently.

4.2 Proposed Solution :

The proposed solution is to develop a Smart Library Request Workflow system using the ServiceNow platform.

Users can submit library requests through a form, which is stored in a database table. Workflow automation processes the request and sends it to the library administrator for approval. Notifications are sent to users regarding the request status.

This automated system improves efficiency and reduces manual effort in managing library requests.

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5. TECHNOLOGY USED

Technology Description

- ServiceNow - Cloud platform used to build and manage IT service applications
- UI Policies - Used to dynamically control field behavior on forms
- UI Actions - Used to trigger actions within records
- Update Sets - Used to capture and migrate configuration changes
- Incident Module - Used for managing incident records

6. IMPLEMENTATION

6.1 Creating an Update Set

Update Sets are used to capture all configuration changes made during development.

Steps to create an Update Set:

1. Log in to the ServiceNow platform.
2. Navigate to System Update Sets.
3. Select Local Update Sets.
4. Click New.
5. Enter the name and description of the update set.
6. Mark the update set as Current.
7. Click Submit.
8. Once the update set is set as current, all configuration changes will be stored in it.

6.2 Creating the UI Policy

UI Policies allow administrators to control field behavior such as visibility, read-only status, and mandatory conditions.

Steps to create the UI Policy:

1. Navigate to System UI.
2. Select UI Policies.
3. Click New to create a new policy.
4. Provide the required details such as name and table.
5. Define the condition where State = In Progress.
6. Save the policy.

6.3 Adding UI Policy Actions

After creating the UI Policy, actions must be defined to specify how fields behave.

Steps:

1. Scroll down to the UI Policy Actions section.
2. Click New.
3. Select the Priority field.
4. Set Mandatory = True.
5. Submit the action.
6. Now the priority field will automatically become mandatory whenever the incident state changes to In Progress.

7. TESTING

Testing is performed to verify that the implemented UI Policy works correctly.

Testing Procedure

1. Navigate to the Incident module in ServiceNow.
2. Open an existing incident record or create a new one.

3. Change the State field to In Progress.
4. Try saving the record without filling the priority field.
5. Expected Result
6. The system should prevent the record from being saved until the Priority field is filled.
7. Actual Result
8. The system successfully enforces the rule, and the priority field becomes mandatory when the state is set to In Progress.
9. This confirms that the UI Policy is functioning correctly.

8. ADVANTAGES & DISADVANTAGES :

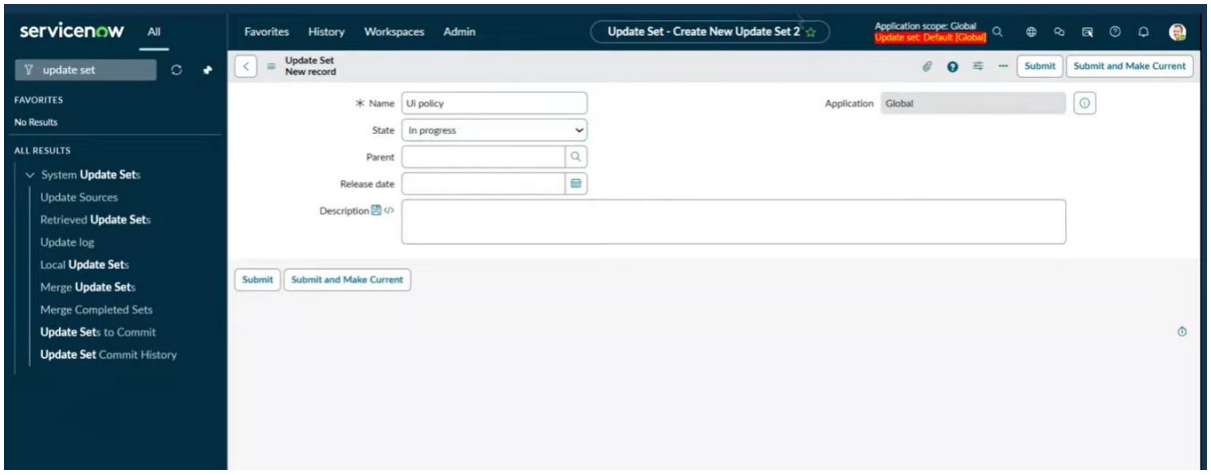
Advantages :

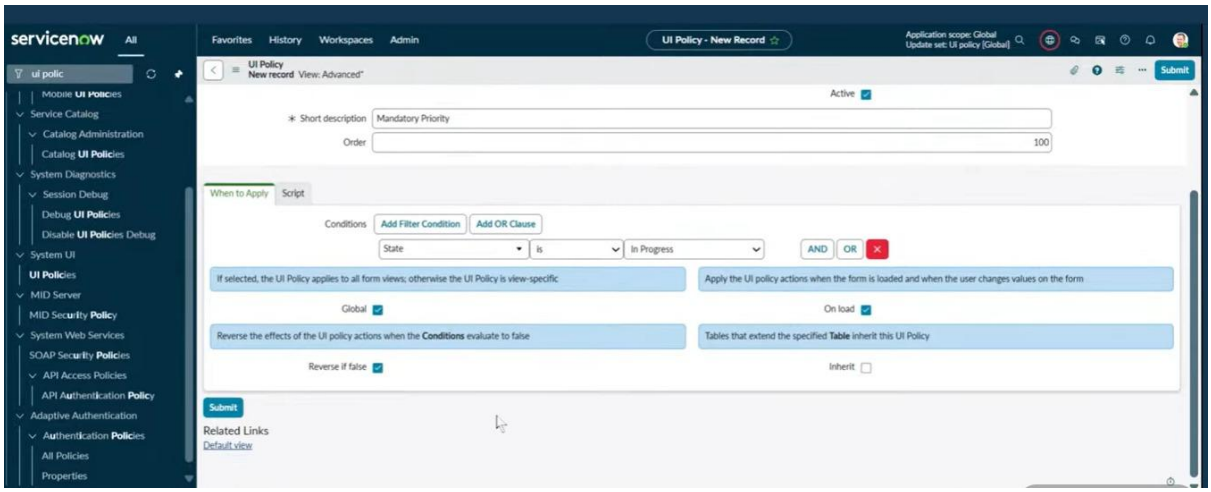
- The implementation of UI Policies provides several advantages
- Ensures data completeness in incident records
- Prevents users from leaving important fields empty
- Improves efficiency of incident management
- Reduces errors in data entry
- Does not require complex scripting
- Easy to implement and maintain

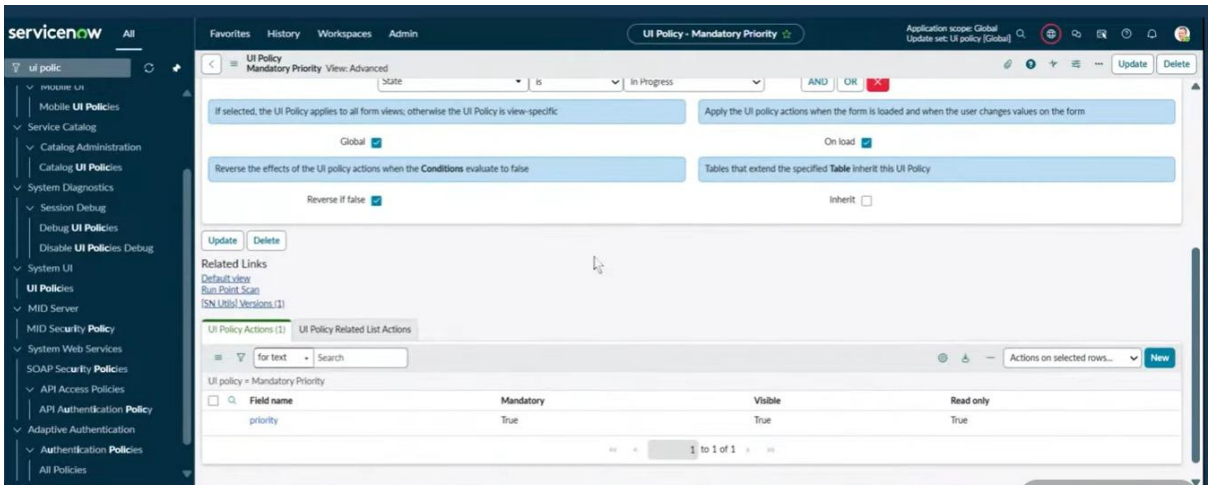
Disadvantages :

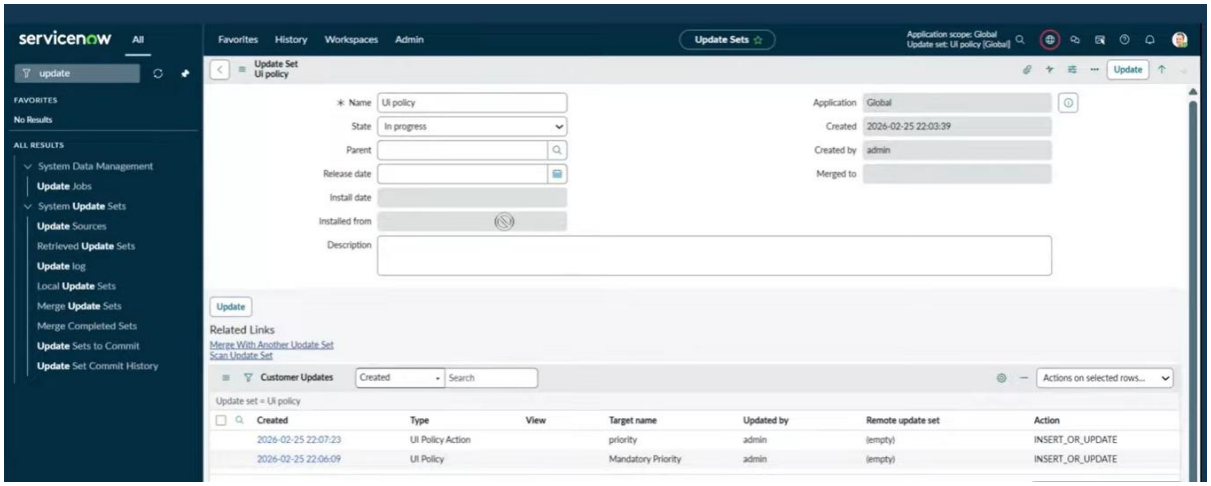
- If UI Policies are not configured properly, they may cause validation errors or prevent users from submitting forms.
- Too many mandatory fields can make the incident form complex and time-consuming for users to fill out.
- UI Policies work only on the user interface, so they may not enforce validation when data is entered through scripts or integrations.
- Managing multiple UI Policies can become difficult in large ServiceNow implementations.

6.SCREENCHOT :





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Update Sets
Application scope: Global
Update set: UI policy [Global]
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No Results
ALL RESULTS
System Data Management
Update Jobs
System Update Sets
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Retrieved Update Sets
Update log
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Merge Update Sets
Merge Completed Sets
Update Sets to Commit
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Update Set
UI policy
Update
Name
UI policy
State
In progress
Parent
Release date
Install date
Installed from
Description
Application
Global
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Created by
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Merged to
Related Links
Merge With Another Update Set
Scan Update Set
Customer Updates
Created
Search
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Created
Type
View
Target name
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Remote update set
Action
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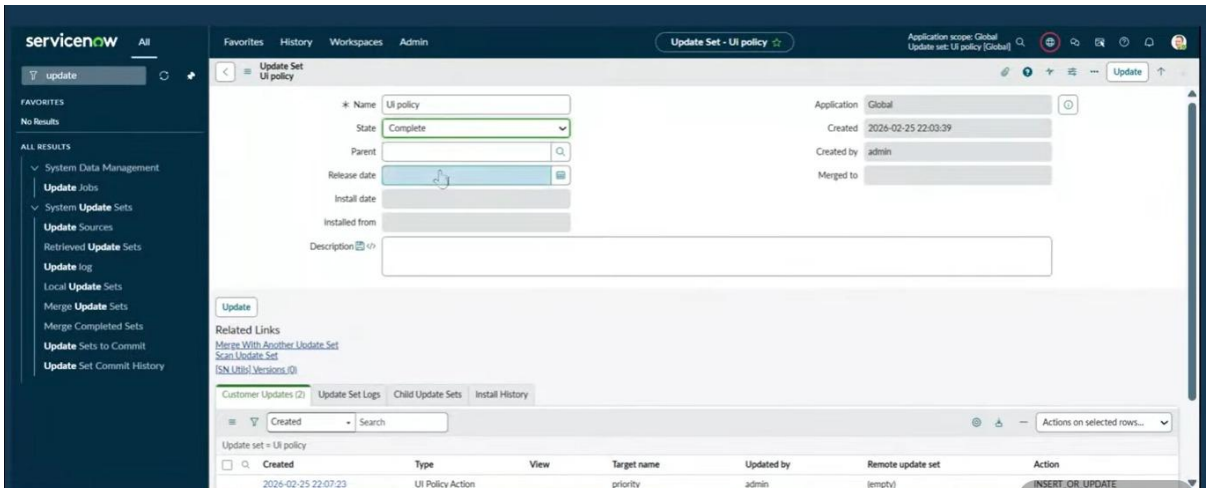
INSERT_OR_UPDATE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Customer Updates (2)
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Child Update Sets
Install History
Created
Search
Actions on selected rows...
Update set = UI policy
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View
Target name
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Action
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UI Policy Action
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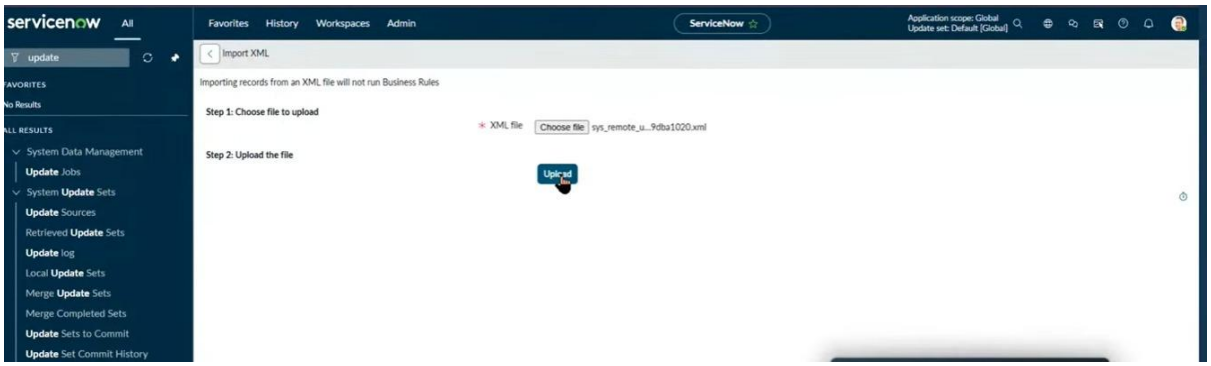
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ServiceNow
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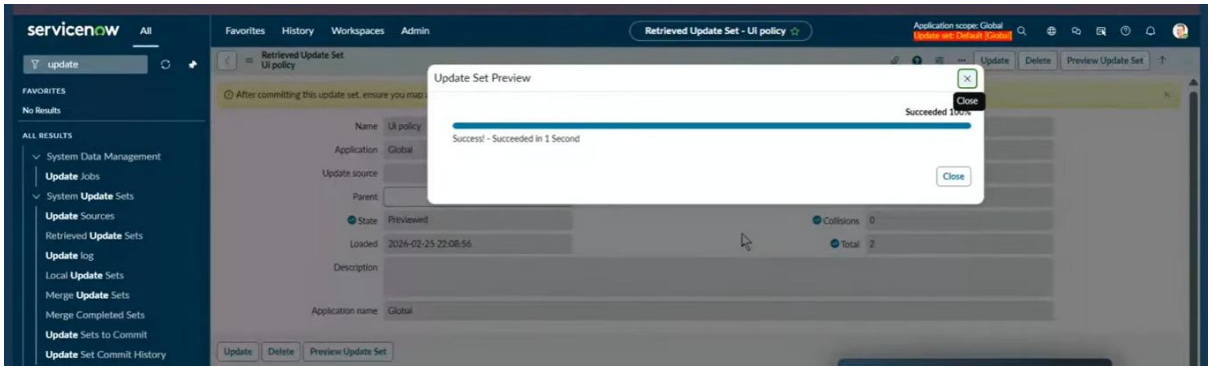
Update log
Local Update Sets
Merge Update Sets
Merge Completed Sets
Update Sets to Commit
Update Set Commit History
Import XML
Importing records from an XML file will not run Business Rules
Step 1: Choose file to upload
XML file
Choose file
sys_remote_u...9dba1020.xml
Step 2: Upload the file
Upload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UI policy
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Preview Update Set
Update Set Preview
Close
Succeeded 100%
Success! - Succeeded in 1 Second
Name
UI policy
Application
Global
Update source
Parent
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Collisions
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Total
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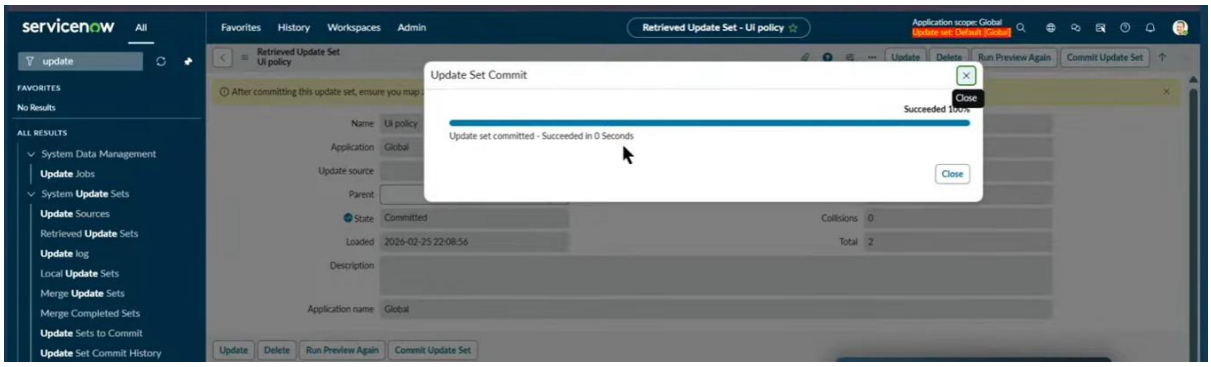
Description
Application name
Global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Update Sets to Commit
Update Set Commit History
Retrieved Update Set
UI policy
Update
Delete
Run Preview Again
Commit Update Set
Update Set Commit
Close
Succeeded 100%
Update set committed - Succeeded in 0 Seconds
Name
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Application
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State
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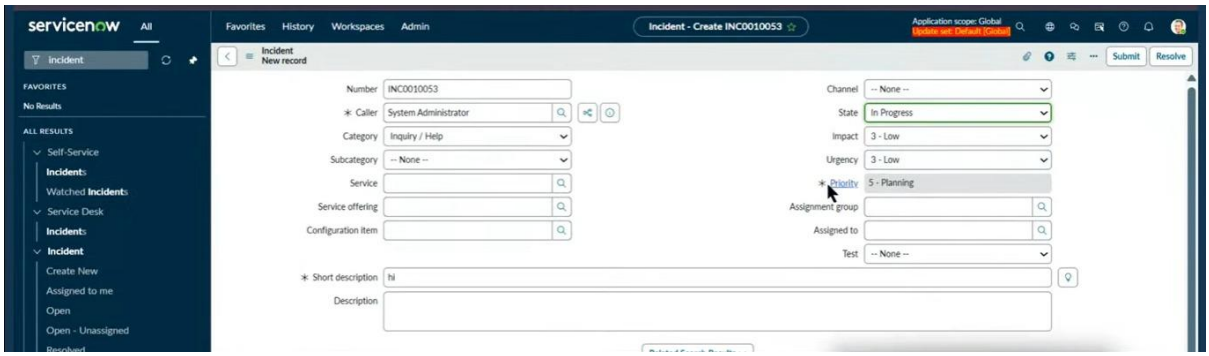
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Update set: Default [Global]
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FAVORITES
No Results
ALL RESULTS
Self-Service
Incidents
Watched Incidents
Service Desk
Incidents
Incident
Create New
Assigned to me
Open
Open - Unassigned
Incident
New record
Submit
Resolve
Number
INC0010053
Caller
System Administrator
Category
Inquiry / Help
Subcategory
-- None --
Service
Service offering
Configuration item
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Priority
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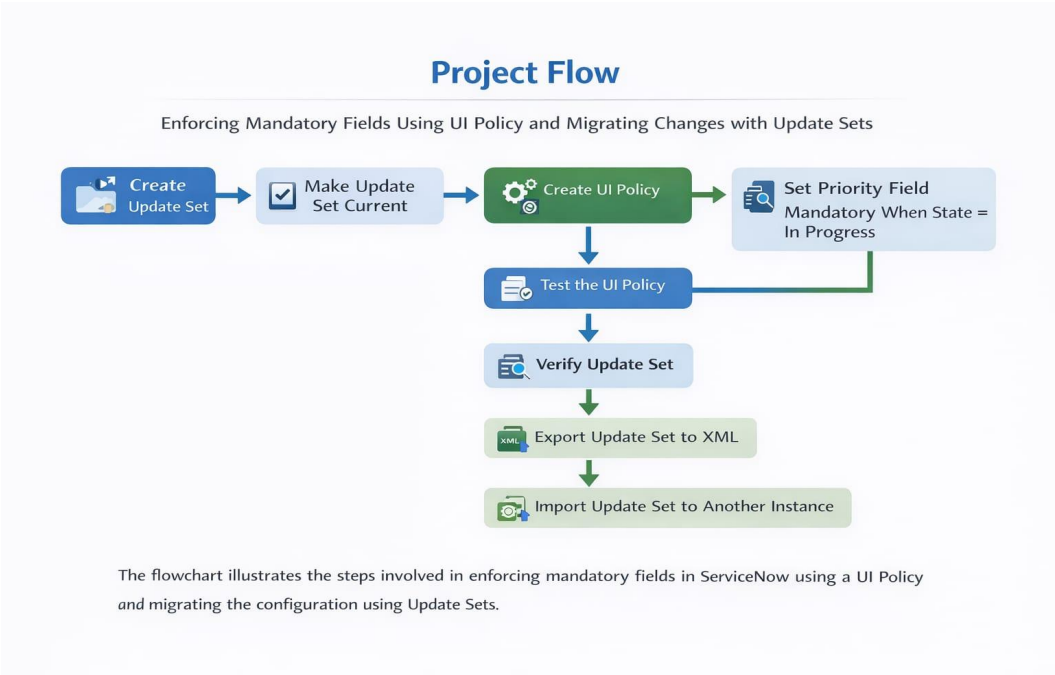
Description



7. CONCLUSION :

This project demonstrates how UI Policies in ServiceNow can enforce business rules without using scripts. The Priority field is made mandatory when the incident State is set to “In Progress,” ensuring important information is captured and improving incident management. The project also shows how Update Sets are used to migrate configuration changes between different ServiceNow instances.

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8. FUTURE SCOPE :

In the future, this project can be improved by adding more validation rules, automated notifications for high-priority incidents, and integration with other ServiceNow modules. Reporting features and mobile access can also be added to make incident management more efficient and user-friendly.